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SPORTSPERSONS



LATEST NEWS: Full UK ETA Enforcement Announced for February 2026 (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/full-uk-eta-enforcen>

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SPORTSPERSONS

The UK is a top destination for athletes and sporting professionals in a diverse range of disciplines. Whether you are a sportsperson, coach or club, our immigration barristers are well versed in the full range of UK visas available to sportspersons who wish to visit, or work in, the UK.

UK Visas and Immigration Routes for Sportspersons

If you want to work as a sportsperson, undertaking sporting activities in the UK, you will normally need an International Sportsperson visa. You will need to be sponsored on a short or long-term contract and have been endorsed by an appropriate UK sports governing body. However, if you are going to be in the UK briefly, or for a single event or activity, one of the visitor visas may be appropriate.

The main immigration routes available to sportspersons are:

- Sports Visitor (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/personal-immigration/short-stay-visit-visas/sports-visit-visa/>)
- Permitted Paid Engagement (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/personal-immigration/short-stay-visit-visas/permitted-paid-engagement-visit-visa/>)
- International Sportsperson (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/personal-immigration/long-term-work-visas/international-sportsperson-visa/>)

Download Our Guide To

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Immigration Routes For

Routes-For-Sportspersons.pdf)

Sportspersons

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Employers, clubs and event organisers

immigration barristers

(https://www.google.co.uk) If you want to employ someone who does not already have the right to work in the UK, you will need to sponsor them. All companies and organisations who want to sponsor their employees must obtain a Sponsor Licence.

To sponsor a sportsperson under the International Sportsperson route, you must be a UK-based sporting body, sports club, events organiser or other organiser operating in the sporting sector. Agents and overseas-based sports clubs and organisations cannot sponsor workers on the International Sportsperson route.

You will need to obtain an endorsement from the governing body for your sport, which must be recognised by the Home Office. The endorsement will confirm that you are a genuine club or similar organisation and have a legitimate requirement to bring migrants to the UK as sportspersons. If the governing body for your sport is not recognised by the Home Office, it is important to ensure you plan well ahead if intending to sponsor any migrants, as it can take up to 6 months for a governing body to be added to the approved list.

Players on loan: if you sponsor a sportsperson you will have special duties if they are on loan to another club. You can only loan and accept loaned players if the sports player has permission as an International Sportsperson, they are sponsored by a sports club and player loans are specifically permitted by the relevant sports governing body. The player may only be loaned if they will return to your club after the loan period. You will continue to be responsible for the player and must make arrangements with the loan club so that you can continue to meet your sponsor duties. The loan club does not need to make an application for an endorsement or have a Sponsor Licence.

How Our Immigration Barristers Can Help

Our immigration barristers provide expert advice to sportspersons, coaches and clubs on UK visa and immigration requirements. We assist professional and amateur sportspersons, employers and event organisers across all sports to ensure that they can visit and undertake sporting activities in the UK.

WE CAN ALSO ASSIST WITH

Applications for Sports Visitor Visas

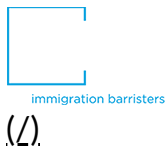


Applications for Permitted Paid Engagement Visas



Applications for International Sportsperson Visas





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WHAT CAN WE HELP YOU WITH?

To arrange an initial consultation meeting with a member of our team, contact our immigration barristers on 020 3617 9173 or complete our enquiry form.

open

LATEST ARTICLES EXPERT COMMENT AND INSIGHT FROM OUR IMMIGRATION TEAM

UK Visa & Immigration Routes for Sportspersons

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/uk-visa-immigration-routes-for-sportspersons/>)

By Paul Richmond - Managing Partner

22 Apr 2022

The UK has a range of immigration routes that provide both temporary and long-term opportunities for international sports persons to participate in sporting activities in the UK. The main immigration routes open...

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/uk-visa-immigration-routes-for-sportspersons/>)

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How to Apply for an International Sportsperson Visa

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/how-to-apply-for-an-international-sportsperson-visa/>)

By Richmond Chambers -

06 Dec 2021

If you are an elite sportsperson or qualified sports coach, over the age of 16, and wanting to enter the UK, the International Sportsperson visa route may be of interest to you. You will need to be recognised...

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T2 and T5 Sports Visa Routes - What's the difference?

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/t2-and-t5-sports-visa-routes-whats-the-difference/>)

By Paul Richmond - Managing Partner

23 Aug 2021

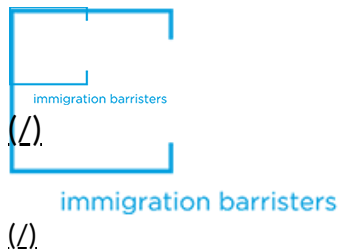
As we discussed in our earlier post, the UK has a range of immigration routes for sports persons seeking to participate in sporting activities in the UK on either a temporary or long-term basis. Among the...

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